

Work From Home Policy

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. — Internal Policy Document

Document Code	Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner
TN-HR-003	1.6	01 April 2026	HR & People Team

Purpose and Scope

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. follows a hybrid working model that combines in-office collaboration with flexibility to work from home. This policy sets out eligibility, entitlement, and expectations for Work From Home (WFH) arrangements. It applies to all confirmed employees whose role does not require a fixed on-site presence (e.g., facilities, front-desk, or lab-based roles are excluded unless otherwise agreed with HR).

Why TechNova Follows a Hybrid Model

TechNova adopted a structured hybrid model in 2020, balancing the flexibility employees value with the collaboration, mentorship, and culture-building benefits of in-person work. Internal feedback surveys and team performance data are reviewed periodically by HR and Function Heads to confirm the WFH cadence remains right for the business and for employees; any change to the standard 8-day entitlement is communicated at least 60 days in advance.

Standard WFH Entitlement

Employees in eligible roles may work from home for up to **8 days per month** (an average of 2 days per week), in agreement with their manager. Employees are expected to be present in the office on the remaining working days to support in-person collaboration, team ceremonies, and client interactions.

Team Type	Typical WFH Pattern
Engineering / Product	Up to 8 days/month; core in-office days for sprint planning and design reviews.
Sales / Customer Success	Aligned to client meeting schedules; WFH days agreed with manager weekly.
Support (24x7 rotations)	WFH permitted for remote-capable shifts, subject to team roster.
New joiners (first 90 days)	Primarily in-office to support onboarding and team integration; see Onboarding Guide.

Requesting and Recording WFH

- Mark planned WFH days in advance on the HR Portal under "Attendance → Work From Home", or via the team calendar if the manager uses that method.
- For ad-hoc, same-day WFH (e.g., due to a plumber visit or minor illness), inform the manager as early as possible and log it on the HR Portal before the end of the day.
- Managers may set team-level guidelines (e.g., a shared in-office day) as long as they remain within the 8-day monthly WFH entitlement.

Fully Remote Roles

A limited number of roles may be approved as fully remote (little to no regular office presence) based on business need, typically for specialised technical roles or employees based outside the four office cities. Fully remote status requires Function Head and HR approval and is documented in the employee's HR record; it is reviewed annually.

Expectations While Working From Home

- Be reachable and responsive during core hours (9:30 AM – 6:30 PM IST), including for scheduled meetings and stand-ups.
- Maintain a reasonably quiet, professional environment for video calls; camera-on is expected for team meetings unless otherwise agreed.
- Ensure a stable internet connection; the Company internet reimbursement (below) is intended to support this.
- Follow the same data-security practices as in the office — see the Security Policy for requirements on device locking, VPN use, and confidential information handling at home.
- Attendance and deliverables are tracked the same way as in-office days; WFH is not a substitute for leave.

WFH From a Different City or Country

Short-term WFH from another city within India (e.g., visiting family) is permitted for up to 15 consecutive days with manager approval, provided connectivity and working hours are maintained. WFH from outside India requires prior approval from HR and Legal due to tax, data-protection, and compliance considerations, and is generally limited to a maximum of 30 days per year.

Equipment and Home Office Setup

Item	Provision
Laptop	Issued by IT as the employee's primary work device; see IT Policy for asset terms.
Monitor / keyboard / mouse (optional)	May be issued from office stock on request, subject to availability, for employees with an approved hybrid or remote arrangement.
Internet reimbursement	Up to INR 1,000 per month against a broadband bill in the employee's name, claimed via the Reimbursement Policy process.

Item	Provision
Ergonomic assessment	Available on request through HR; see Employee Handbook, Workplace Health and Safety.

In-Office Days: Desk Booking and Team Norms

On days an employee comes into the office, desks in most teams are unassigned and can be reserved through the "Workspace" tab on the HR Portal to guarantee availability, particularly at the Bangalore campus. Many teams designate one or two common in-office days (e.g., Tuesday/Thursday) to maximise in-person collaboration time; employees should follow their team's agreed pattern in addition to the overall 8-day monthly WFH cap.

Meetings and Ceremonies That Require Office Presence

- Quarterly planning and OKR review sessions.
- In-person client visits or vendor meetings scheduled at the office.
- New-hire onboarding sessions during an employee's first two weeks (see Onboarding Guide).
- Any session explicitly flagged "in-person required" by the meeting organiser, with reasonable notice.

Employees should plan their WFH days around these fixed in-office commitments rather than the reverse; managers will share known in-person dates as early as possible.

Returning from Extended Leave

Employees returning from Maternity, Adoption, or extended medical leave may request a temporary increase in WFH days (up to full-time WFH for a defined period, typically up to 4 weeks) to ease the transition back to work, subject to role suitability and manager agreement, as referenced in the Leave Policy.

IT Support While Working Remotely

The IT Helpdesk provides the same support for remote employees as in-office employees, through remote-assist tools, a dedicated WFH support queue, and, where a hardware issue cannot be resolved remotely, a courier pickup/replacement service for the affected device. See the IT Policy for helpdesk contact details and standard resolution timelines.

Security and Confidentiality at Home

- Connect to Company systems only over the TechNova VPN when accessing internal tools from outside the office network.
- Lock your screen whenever stepping away from your device, even at home.
- Avoid discussing confidential client or Company information within earshot of household members or on speakerphone in shared spaces.

- Do not print confidential documents at home unless strictly necessary, and dispose of any printed material securely.
- Report a lost or stolen device immediately to the IT Helpdesk, exactly as you would in the office; see the Security Policy for the full incident process.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Plan and log WFH days, stay reachable during core hours, maintain security practices at home.
Manager	Set team-level in-office norms, approve fully remote and cross-city requests, monitor team collaboration health.
HR	Approve fully remote status and extended WFH after leave; review policy annually.
IT	Support remote connectivity, VPN access, and device issues for WFH employees.

WFH and Leave Interaction

WFH days and leave days are recorded separately. An employee who is unwell should apply for Sick Leave rather than marking the day as WFH and attempting to work. Public holidays and approved leave take precedence over any planned WFH day for that date.

Common Scenarios

Scenario	Guidance
I need to WFH for 3 days this week due to a family event.	Check your remaining monthly WFH balance on the HR Portal, discuss with your manager, and log the days in advance.
My internet is down and I cannot join a scheduled meeting.	Inform your manager immediately; dial in by phone if possible, or reschedule. This is not treated as an attendance issue if flagged promptly.
I want to work from my hometown for two weeks.	Permitted up to 15 consecutive days within India with manager approval; log the dates and location on the HR Portal.
I am relocating abroad temporarily and want to keep working.	Requires HR and Legal approval in advance due to tax and compliance considerations; contact hr@technova.example before making plans.

Tax and Compliance Considerations for Cross-Border WFH

Working from outside India, even temporarily, can create tax or regulatory obligations for both the employee and TechNova in the host country. This is why cross-border WFH requires advance review by HR and Legal, and is capped at 30 days per year. Employees should not make travel or accommodation commitments for cross-border WFH before receiving written approval.

Performance and Manager Discretion

WFH is a flexibility benefit, not an entitlement independent of performance and team needs. A manager may temporarily reduce an individual's WFH days (with reasons communicated to the employee) where there are specific, documented concerns about responsiveness, output, or team collaboration, in consultation with HR. Any such adjustment should be time-bound and reviewed.

Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
How many WFH days can I take per month?	Up to 8 days per month (an average of 2 days per week), agreed with your manager.
Do I need to apply for WFH like leave?	Yes, mark it on the HR Portal in advance where possible, or the same day for ad-hoc WFH.
Can I work from home indefinitely?	Only if your role is approved as fully remote by your Function Head and HR; otherwise the standard 8-day/month entitlement applies.
Can I work from another city?	Yes, up to 15 consecutive days within India with manager approval; outside India requires HR and Legal approval.

Contact and Escalation

For questions about WFH eligibility or a fully remote request, contact your HR Business Partner or write to hr@technova.example.

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change
1.0	Apr 2020	Introduced during transition to hybrid working.
1.4	Apr 2023	Standardised WFH entitlement to 8 days/month across teams.
1.6	Apr 2026	Added cross-city/country WFH and internet reimbursement cap.